Digital Education Council Global AI Faculty Survey 2025

AI Meets Academia: What Faculty Think

DEC Leadership Note

It is our pleasure to publish this report as a follow-on to our Global AI Student Survey, which was released publicly in August 2024. The response from around the world was overwhelming and we are delighted to see our data used to inform important discussions in the global higher education community.

This survey reveals a clear message: faculty are deeply engaged with the rapid rise of AI but are calling for stronger institutional support, clearer governance frameworks, and improved AI literacy to harness its potential. While optimism about AI's role in teaching and research is high, concerns around ethics, workload, and skill readiness persist.

The results are a wake-up call for higher education leaders. Faculty see AI as both an opportunity and a challenge, urging institutions to invest in training, policy development, and technology infrastructure to remain competitive in a rapidly changing landscape.

As we said in our Student Survey, the AI revolution has a long way to run and we are only at the beginning. Whilst faculty are broadly positive about the use of AI, their institutions need to support them to succeed and meet overall institutional goals.

A detailed Executive Briefing is provided on these survey results to members of the Digital Education Council. We welcome institutions from around the world to join our work.

We would like to thank members and non-members alike who helped us collect the data for this report. Please let us know how you use this and how it impacts your decision making.

Alessandro Di Lullo
Chief Executive Officer

Daniel A. Bielik
President

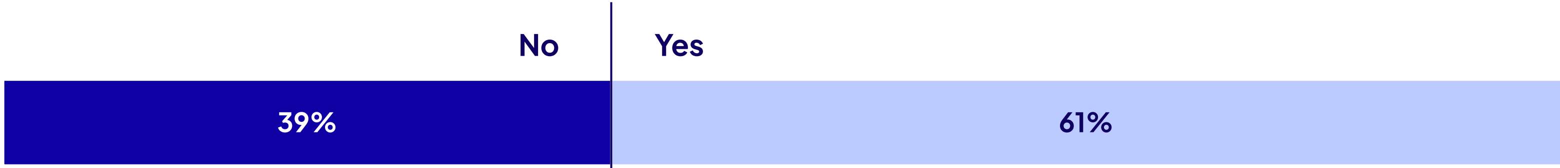
Table of Contents

1. AI in Teaching Today

61% of faculty have used AI in teaching

Faculty usage of AI in teaching, % of respondents

Question: Have you used / are you using AI in your teaching?



39% have not used AI

61% have used AI

AI in teaching and learning

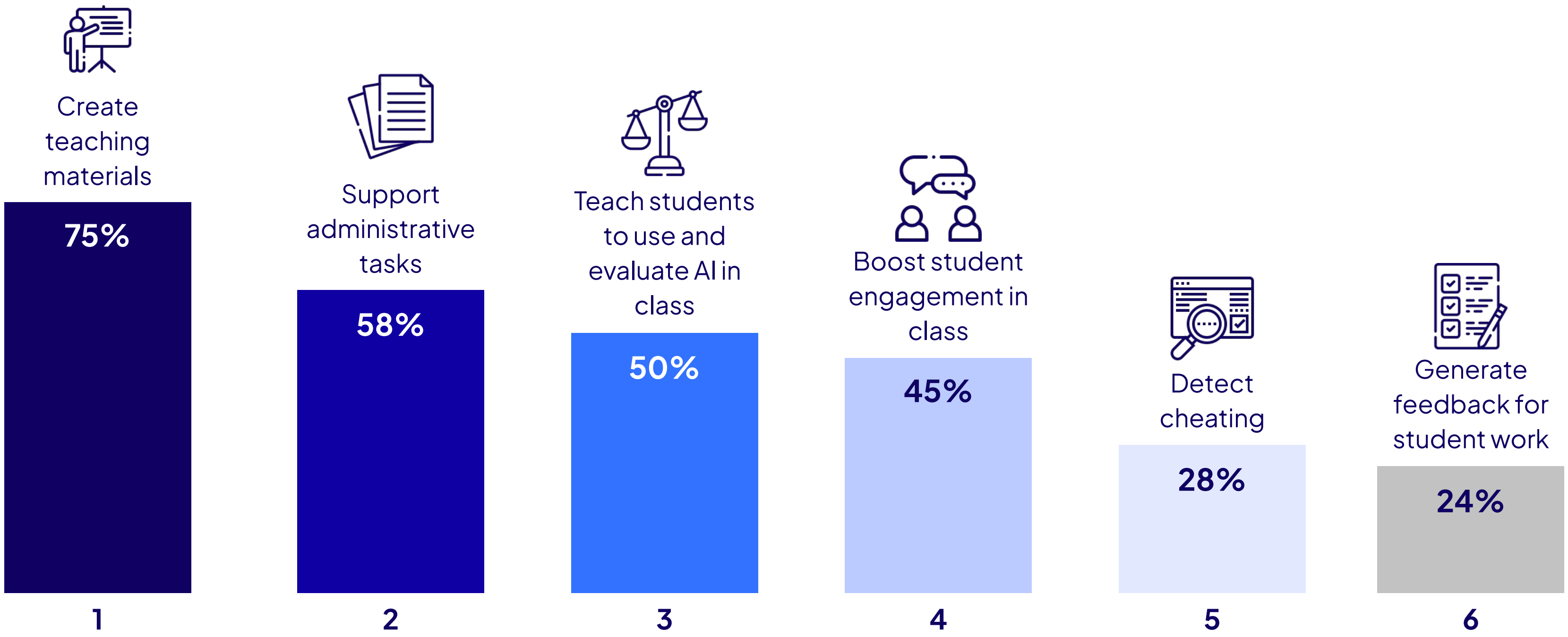
61% of faculty report having used AI in teaching. According to the Digital Education Council Global AI Student Survey 2024, 59% of students expected an increased use of AI in their education.

Top AI use case is creation of teaching materials

Top AI use cases in teaching, % of respondents

Question: What do you use AI for in your teaching? (choose all that apply)

*Responses only include respondents who indicated answered ‘Yes’ to ‘Have you used / are you using AI in your teaching?’



Faculty adopt a cautious approach to AI in teaching

Extent to which faculty use AI in teaching, % of respondents

Question: To what extent do you use AI in your teaching?

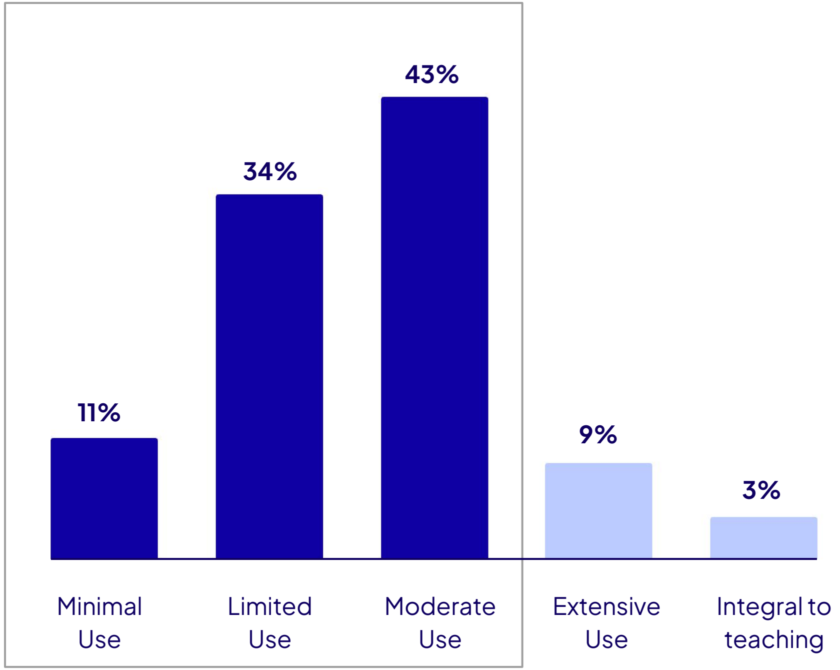
*Responses only include respondents who indicated 'Yes' to 'Have you used / are you using AI in your teaching?'

88%

of faculty who have used AI in teaching report minimal to moderate use

Integrating AI into teaching

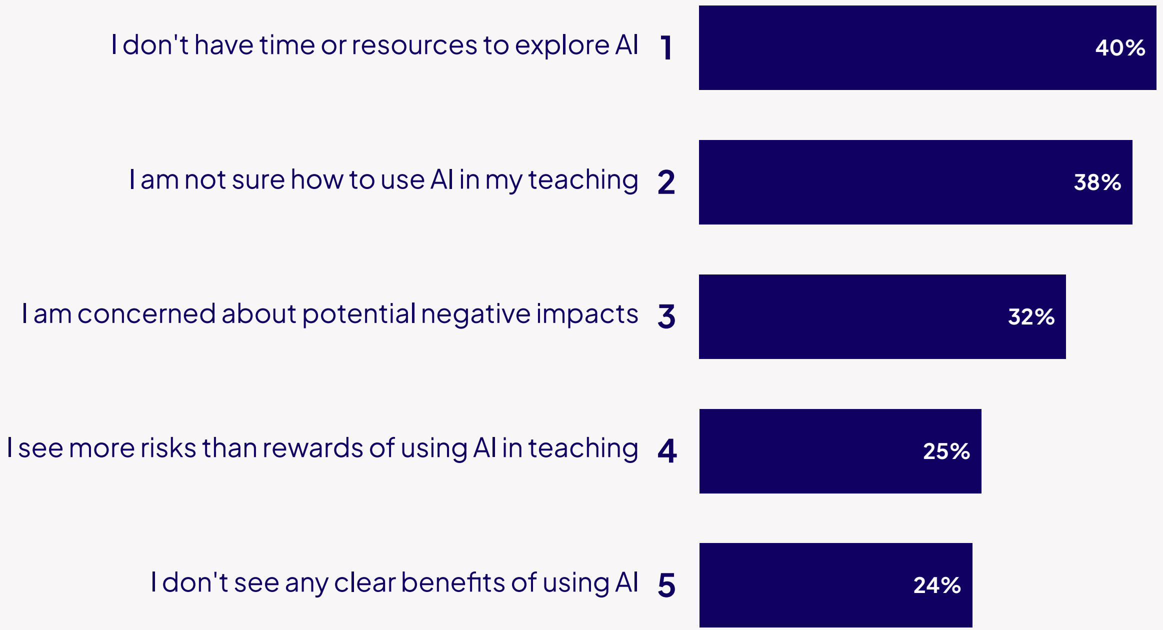
While over 60% of faculty report having used AI in teaching, a significant majority of them indicated that they used AI sparingly. This could be attributed to a lack of clear guidelines and example use cases for AI in teaching provided by institutions, or a deliberate choice on faculty's part to limit usage of AI in teaching.



Time and resources listed as top barriers to use of AI

Top 5 reasons why faculty don't use AI in teaching, % of respondents

Question: What are the reasons you don't use AI in your teaching? (Choose all that apply)
*Responses only include respondents who indicated 'No' to 'Have you used / are you using AI in your teaching?'



2. Faculty Sentiment on AI, Roles, and Skills for the Future

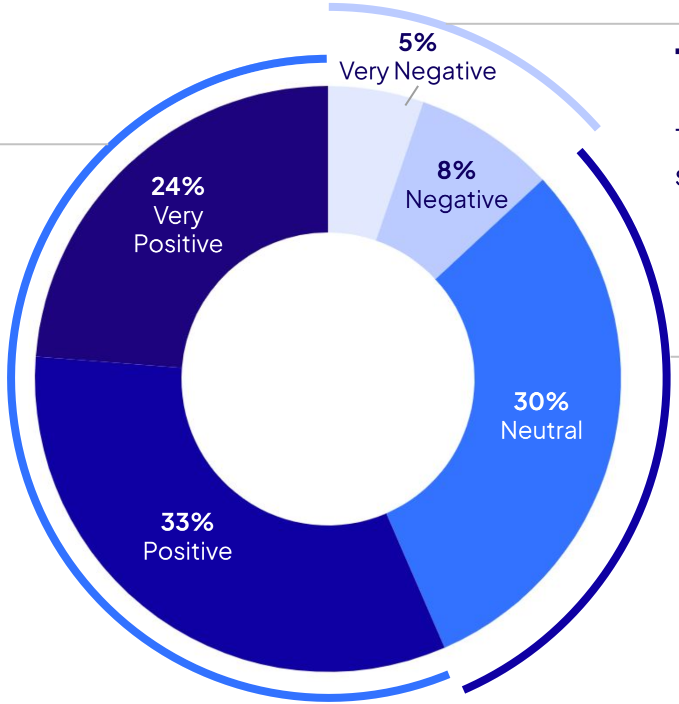
Faculty sentiment on AI divided, with one third staying neutral

Faculty sentiment on AI in education, % of respondents

Question: What is your overall sentiment on AI in education?

57% Positive

57% of faculty have a positive sentiment toward AI



13% Negative

13% of faculty hold a negative sentiment

30% Neutral

30% of faculty took a neutral stance, indicating a substantial proportion of educators are either uncertain or have mixed feelings about AI's impact on education.

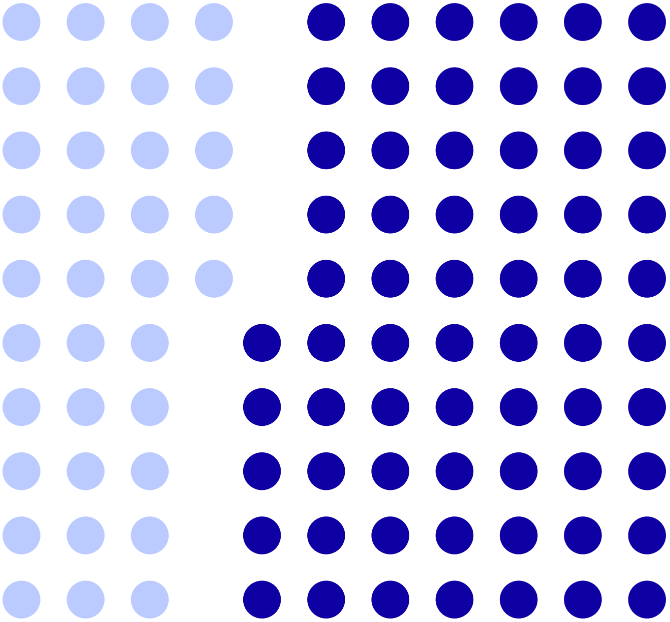
Is AI a challenge or an opportunity?

Faculty sentiment on AI in education, % of respondents

Question: What do you see AI's impact on education as?

35% Challenge

35% of faculty see AI as a challenge



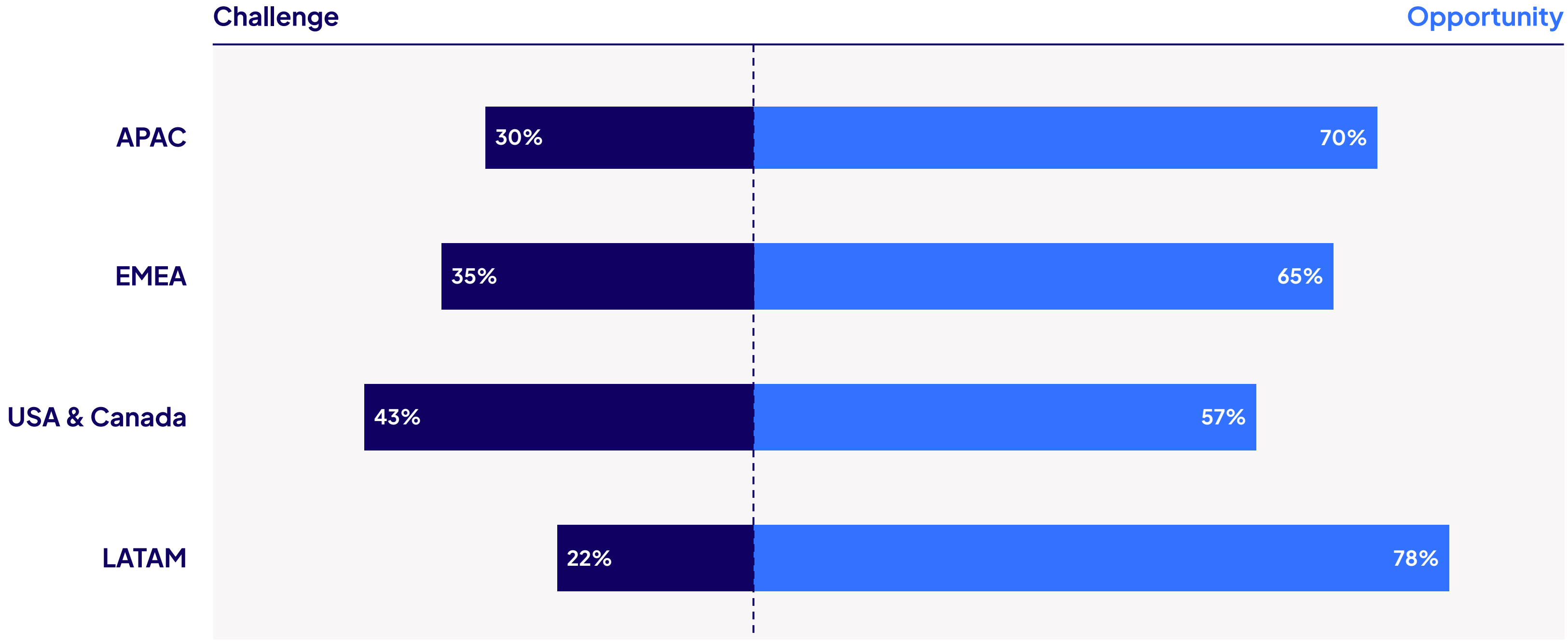
65% Opportunity

65% of faculty see AI as an opportunity

Challenge vs Opportunity: a regional view

Faculty's view on AI's impact on education (by region), % of respondents

Question: What do you see AI's impact on education as?



The sample size in each region was: APAC (n=375), EMEA (n=534), USA & Canada (n=608), LATAM (n=126)

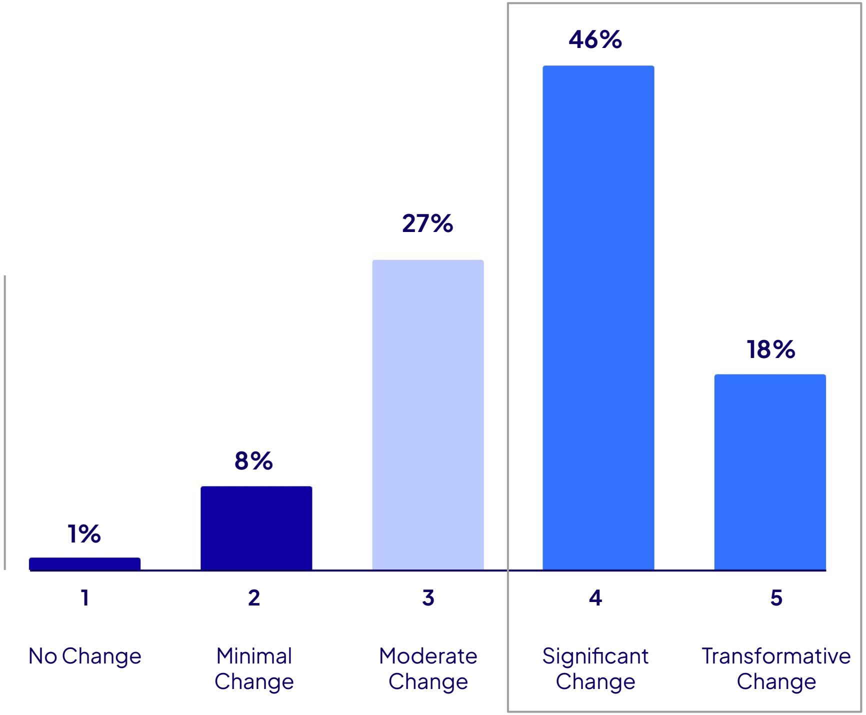
Substantial change is coming to teaching

Faculty perceptions of impact of AI on the role of instructors, % of respondents

Question: How much change do you think AI will bring to your role as an instructor?

9%

Only 9% of faculty believe that AI will bring no to minimal change to the roles of instructors



64%

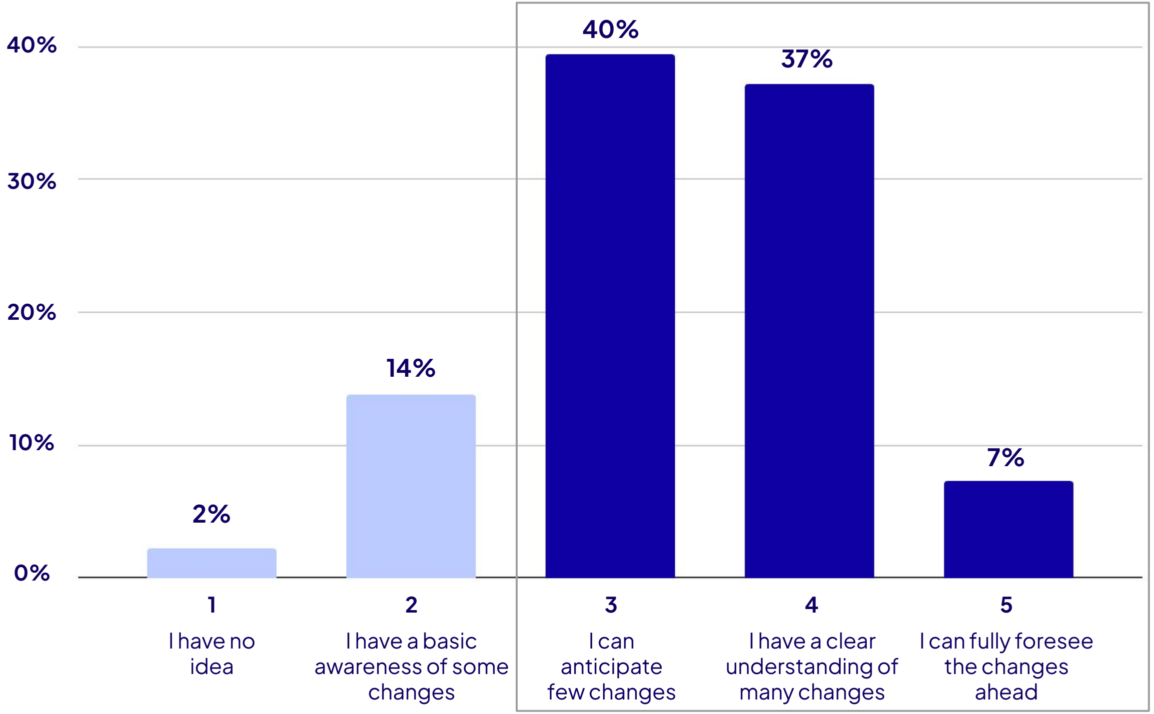
Almost two in three respondents believe that AI will bring significant to transformative change to the roles of instructors.

Faculty anticipate change, but the shape is unclear

Faculty's understanding of impact of AI on role of instructors, % of respondents

Question: How aware are you of the changes that AI is introducing to your role?

*Responses only include respondents who indicated '3–5' to 'How much change do you think AI will bring to your role as an instructor?'



84%

Out of the faculty who felt that AI would bring at least a moderate amount of change to the role of instructors, 84% of them feel that they have at least a clear understanding of many of changes AI could bring.

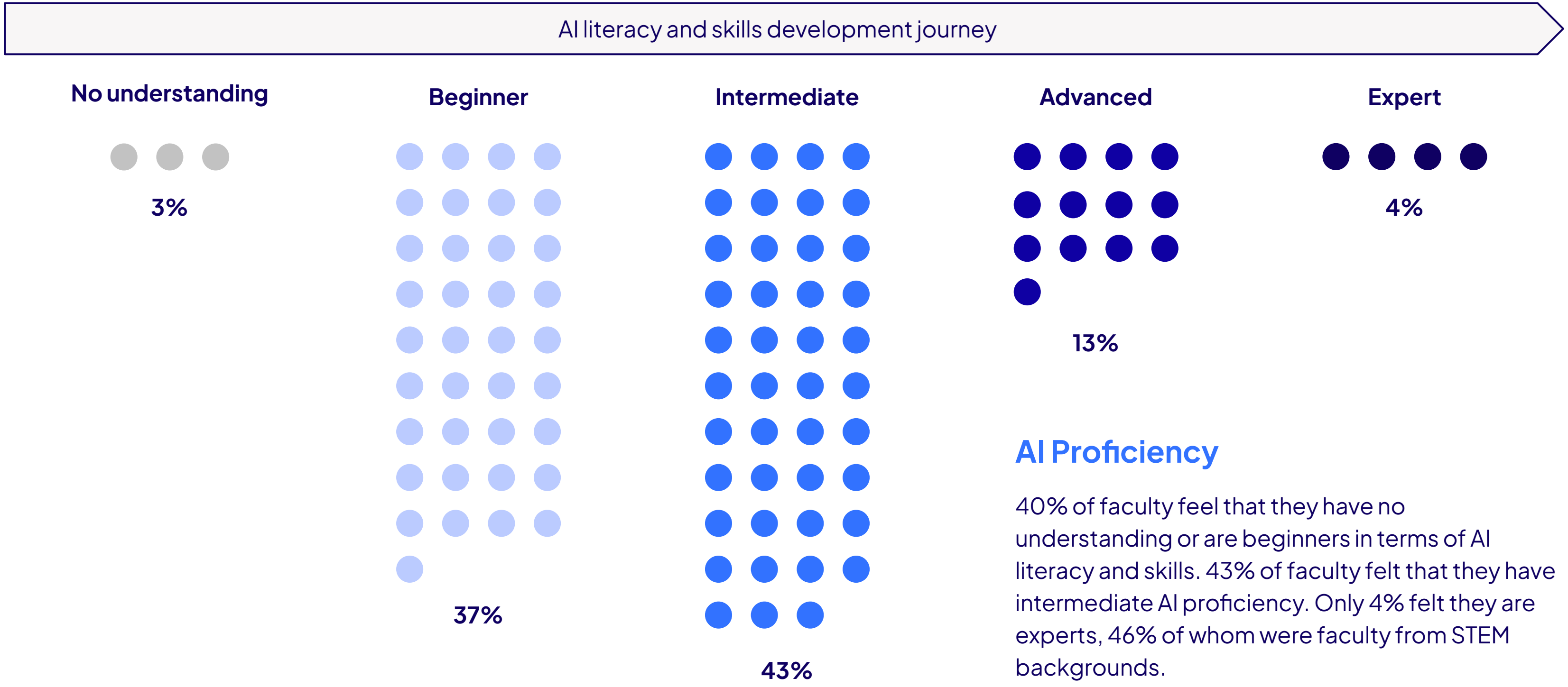
Impact of AI

16% of faculty feel that AI will bring change to teaching, but are not fully aware of the possible changes. This indicates an information gap that education institutions can rectify through AI literacy and skills training.

AI proficiency is an early-stage story

Faculty's AI proficiency, % of respondents

Question: Where are you in your journey of developing AI literacy and skills?



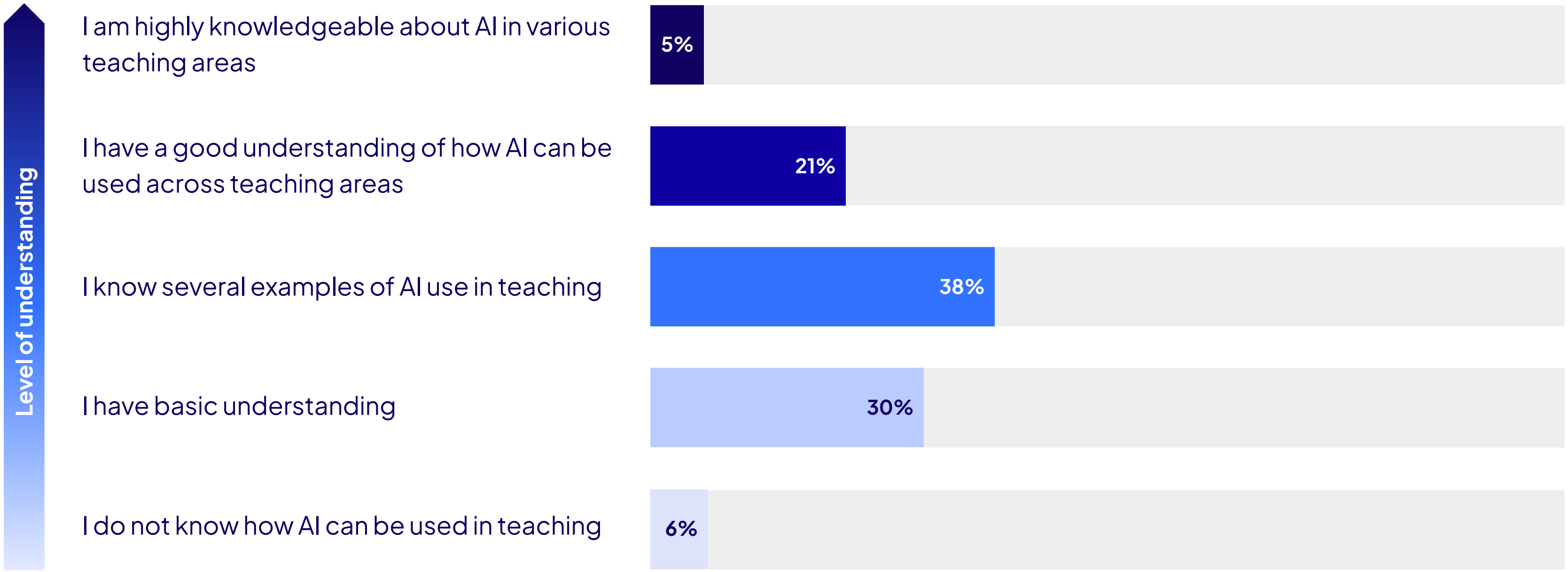
AI Proficiency

40% of faculty feel that they have no understanding or are beginners in terms of AI literacy and skills. 43% of faculty felt that they have intermediate AI proficiency. Only 4% felt they are experts, 46% of whom were faculty from STEM backgrounds.

Faculty understanding of AI in teaching varies

Faculty's understanding of AI's application in teaching, % of respondents

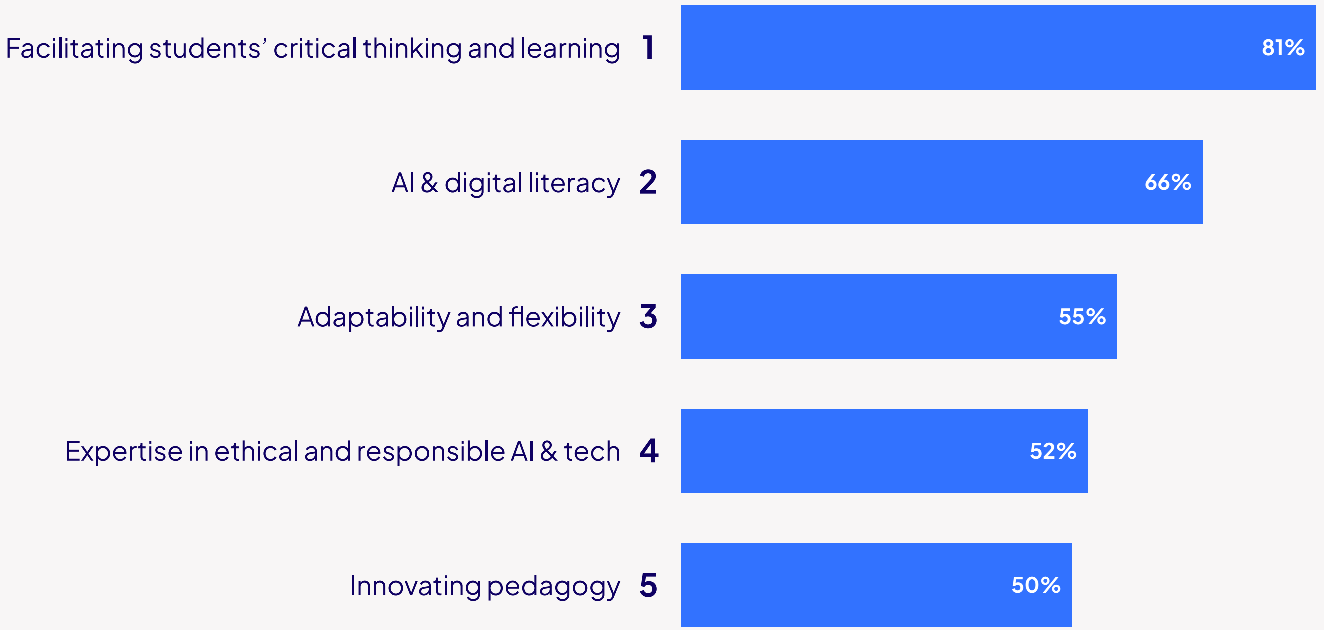
Question: How well do you understand the potential applications of AI in teaching?



Top 5 skills educators need for the AI era

Faculty ranking of skills that educators need in the age of AI and digital

Question: In your view, what are the top skills that an educator needs in the age of AI and digital?



Is AI a threat to faculty jobs?

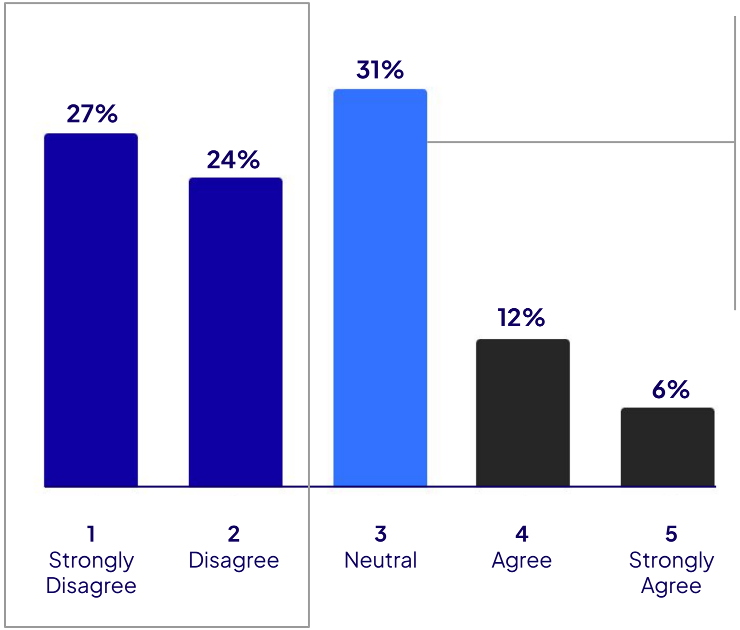
Faculty's view on AI becoming a threat to their job, % of respondents

Question: I am concerned about the following regarding AI integration into teaching:

- AI becoming a threat to my job

51%

Over half of faculty (51%) do not perceive AI as a threat to their jobs.



31%

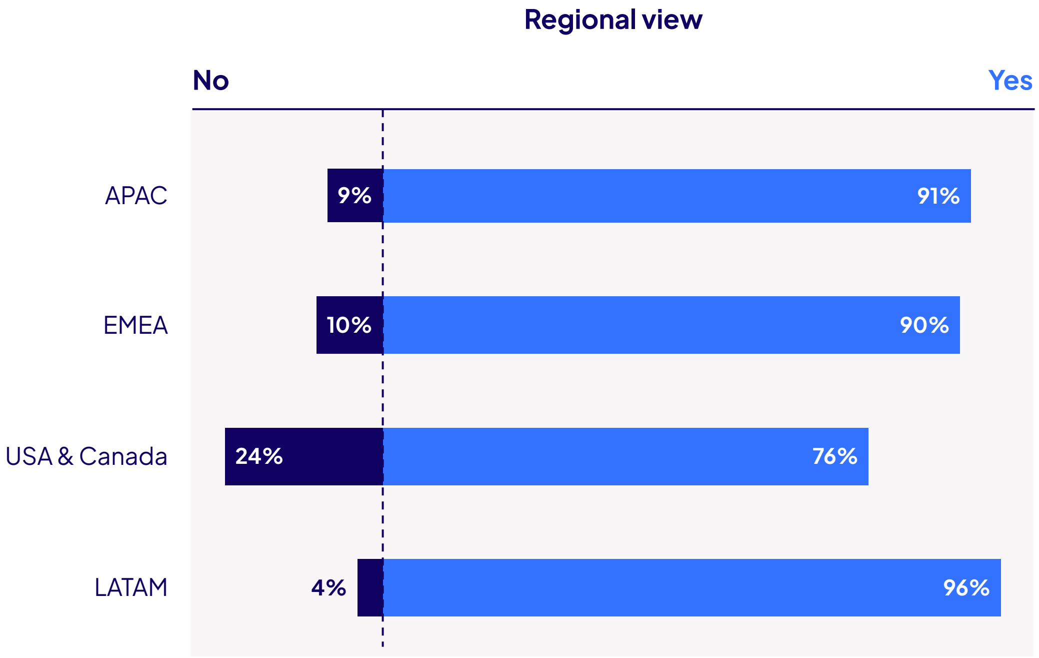
Noticeably, most faculty members (31%) chose a neutral stand on this issue, indicating potential uncertainty about whether AI would impact their job security.

3. AI in Teaching Looking Forward

86% of faculty see themselves using AI in the future

Faculty view on whether they will use AI in teaching in the future, % of respondents

Question: I see myself using AI in my teaching practices in the future



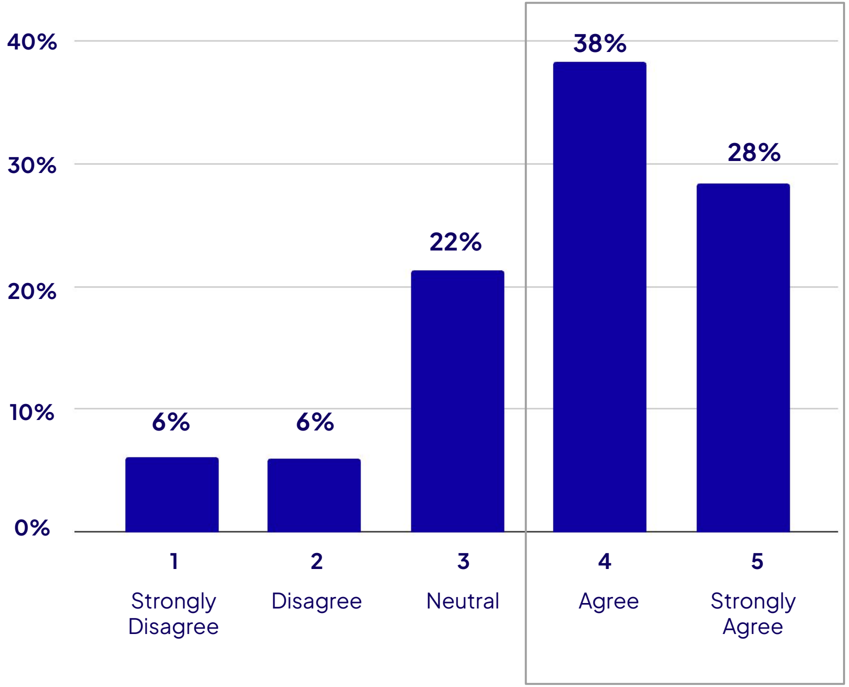
The sample size in each region was: APAC (n=375), EMEA (n=534), USA & Canada (n=608), LATAM (n=126)

Faculty believe future of work calls for AI in teaching

Faculty sentiment on AI's necessity in preparing students for the workforce, % of respondents

Question: To what extent do you agree or disagree with the statement?

- I think incorporating AI in teaching is necessary in preparing my students for future job markets



66%

Two-thirds of faculty agreed that incorporating AI into teaching would be essential in preparing their students for future AI-augmented work environments.

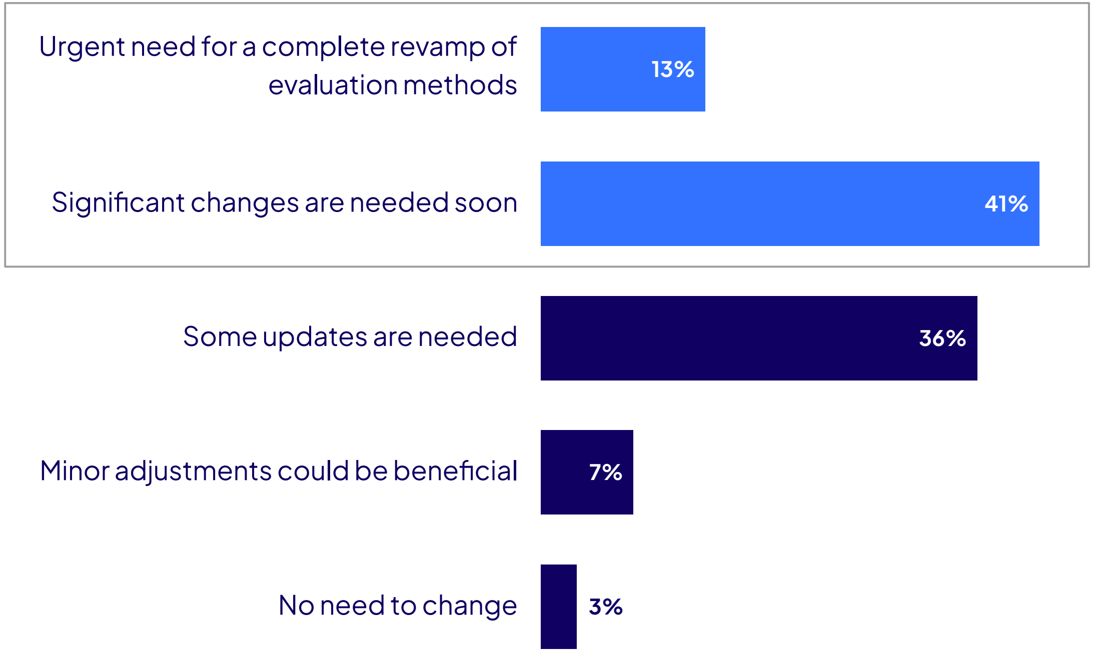
AI in Teaching

According to the Digital Education Council Global AI Student Survey 2024, 52% of students expressed concern that an over-reliance on AI in teaching would decrease the value they receive from education. This highlights the need to balance AI integration in teaching and maintaining quality of teaching and learning.

Faculty call for significant change to student assessments

Faculty view on the need for student evaluation methods update in the age of AI

Question: How do you think student evaluation methods should be updated in response to the impact of AI?



54%

More than half of faculty believe that current student evaluation methods require significant changes, with 13% even calling for an urgent, complete revamp.

Student Assessment

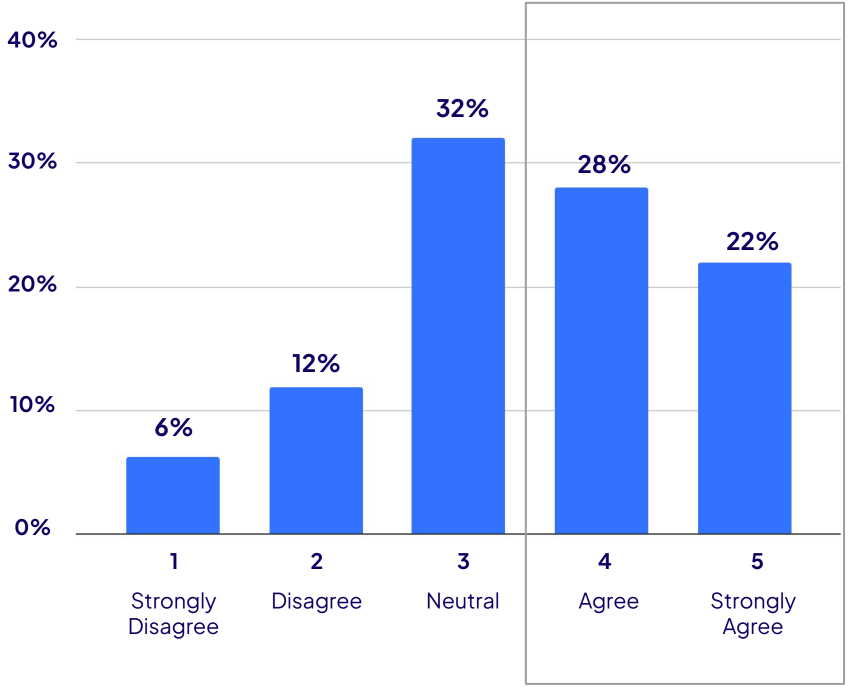
Institutions and educators need to rethink student assessments, focusing not only on how assignments should be redesigned, but also on what essential knowledge and skills need to be evaluated to prepare students for the future workforce.

Half of faculty believe assignment redesign is needed

Faculty's view on the need for assignment redesign, % of respondents

Question: To what extent do you agree or disagree with the statement?

- I will need to redesign my current assignments to make them more AI resistant



50%

Half of faculty members believe that current assignments need to be redesigned to be more AI resistant. This may indicate concerns about AI affecting academic integrity and learning outcomes.

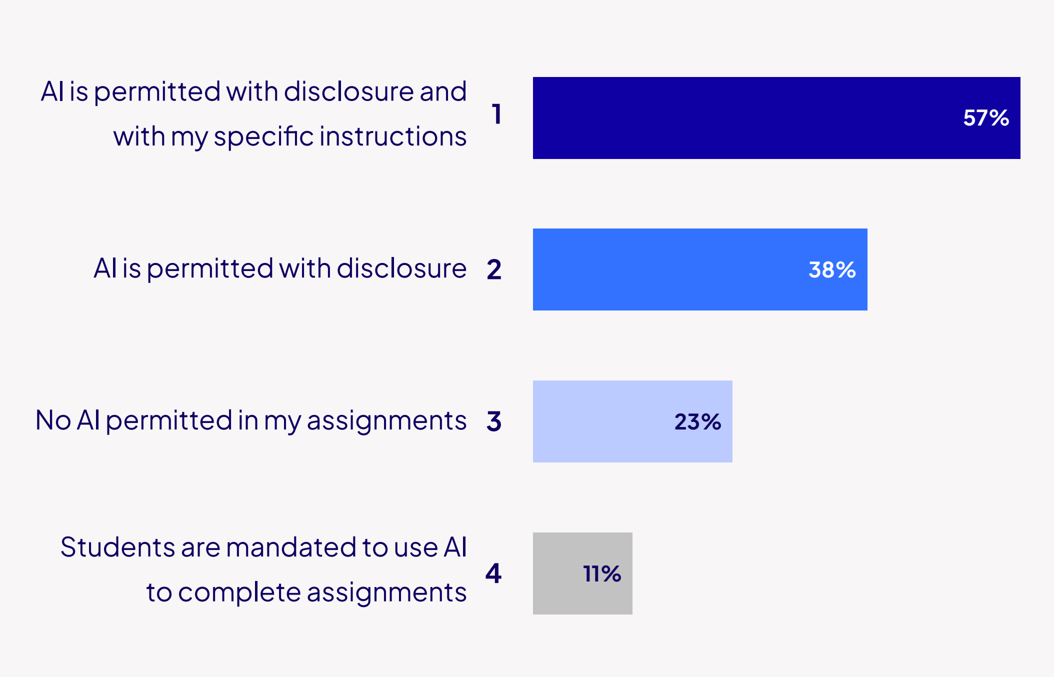
AI in Assignments

The impact of AI on assessments is a key issue tied to AI integration in education. Comprehensive AI governance and guidelines within education institutions on AI use in teaching and learning will be essential in guiding responsible AI integration.

Students are expected to use AI with compliance

Top preferred AI use policies in assignments, % of respondents

Question: Considering your assignments to your students, in which of the following way would you prefer to design your assignments (Choose all that apply)



AI Governance

Over half of faculty (57%) expect their students to use AI with disclosure, together with specific instructions - an approach defined as 'Use with Compliance' in the DEC AI Governance Framework.

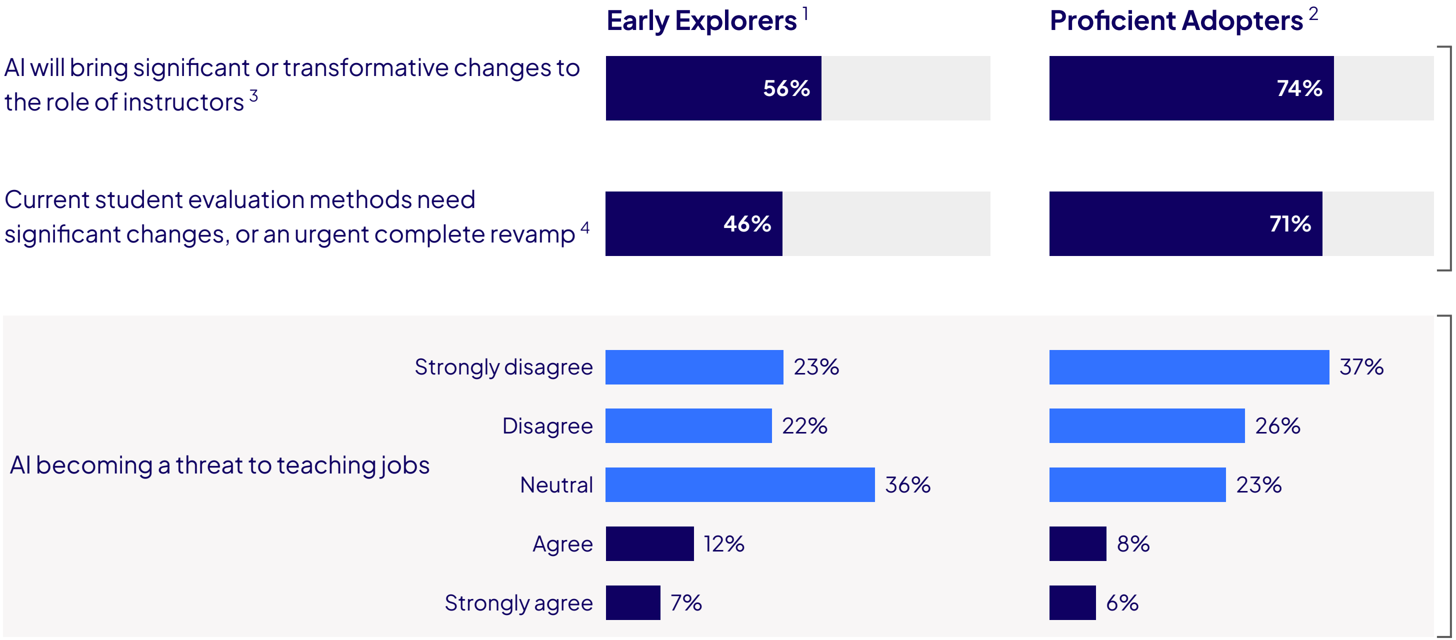
This aligns with our predicted trend that AI usage in education will shift from the less regulated 'Use with Disclosure' phase to the more regulated 'Use with Compliance' phase, as faculty and institutions develop a better understanding of AI's impact and establish more specific guidelines.

Digital Education Council Members please refer to:

- DEC Executive Briefing #006 - Solving the AI Governance Problem
- DEC Executive Briefing #010 - Classifying AI Use Cases in Higher Education

Two faculty personas, two views of the future

Different view on AI held by faculty at different AI proficiency levels, % of respondents



More changes

Proficient Adopters perceive greater transformative change that AI will bring to their role as instructors and to student assessment.

Less threat

Despite expecting greater change, Proficient Adopters see AI as less of a threat to their jobs. This is likely attributed to their perceived readiness for change.

[1] Early Explorers refers to faculty who responded with 'No Understanding' or 'Beginner' in the question 'Where are you in your journey of developing AI literacy and skills?'. Please refer to page 16.
[2] Proficient Adopters refers to faculty who responded with 'Advanced' or 'Expert' in the question 'Where are you in your journey of developing AI literacy and skills?'. Please refer to page 16.
[3] This refers to faculty who responded with 'Significant change' or 'Transformative change' in the question 'How much change do you think AI will bring to your role as an instructor?' Please refer to page 14.
[4] This refers to faculty who responded with 'Significant changes are needed soon' or 'Urgent need for a complete revamp of evaluation methods' in the question 'How do you think student evaluation methods should be updated in response to the impact of AI?' Please refer to page 23.

Faculty keen to explore AI, cautious on grading and analytics

Faculty's opinion on incorporating AI in the following teaching areas, % of respondents

Question:What is your opinion on incorporating AI in the following teaching areas?

AI use cases	Strongly against	Be cautious	I am not sure	Happy to explore	Strongly support
Designing courses	8%	17%	9%	47%	19%
Creating assignments	7%	14%	9%	47%	23%
Creating teaching materials	8%	14%	8%	46%	24%
Grading and generating feedback for student work	15%	22%	17%	33%	13%
Predictive analytics for early intervention	5%	13%	26%	39%	17%
Analysing student course evaluation	9%	19%	20%	39%	13%
Engaging students in class	7%	11%	14%	49%	19%
Teaching student to use and evaluate AI in class	6%	8%	15%	44%	27%
Tutoring and supporting students outside of class	7%	12%	18%	42%	21%

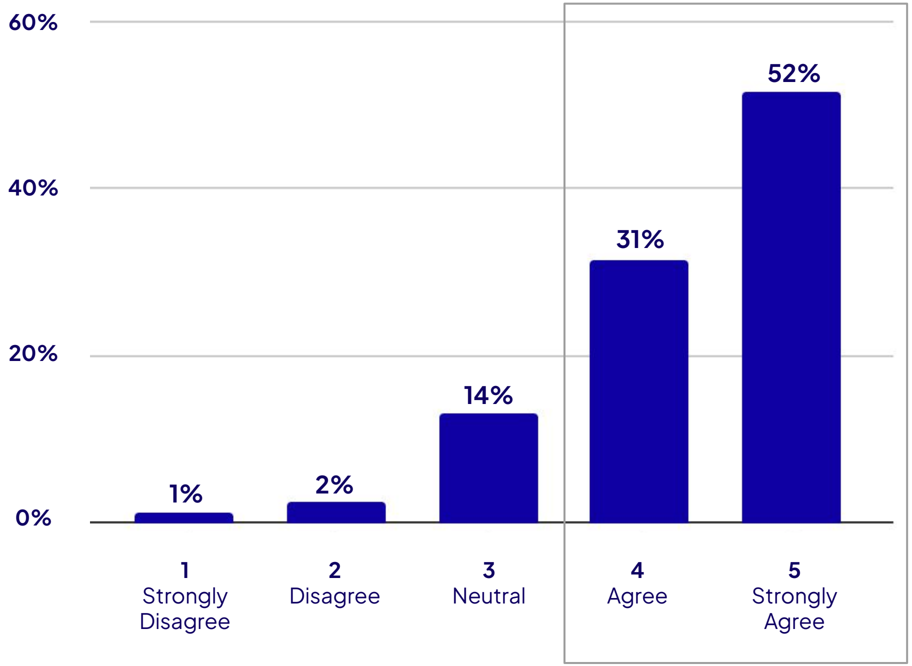
4. Key Concerns

83% of faculty concerned about student ability to evaluate AI

Concerned about student ability to critically evaluate AI output, % of respondents

Question: I am concerned about the following regarding AI integration into teaching:

- Ability of students to critically evaluate AI-generated output



83%

A significant majority (83%) of faculty members expressed concern about student ability to critically evaluate AI-generated output, with more than half of them expressing serious concerns.

Critical Thinking Skills

Critical thinking has emerged as a central topic in discussions about AI's impact on education. Facilitating students' critical thinking and learning is also voted as the most important skill that educator needs in the the age of AI and digital.[1]

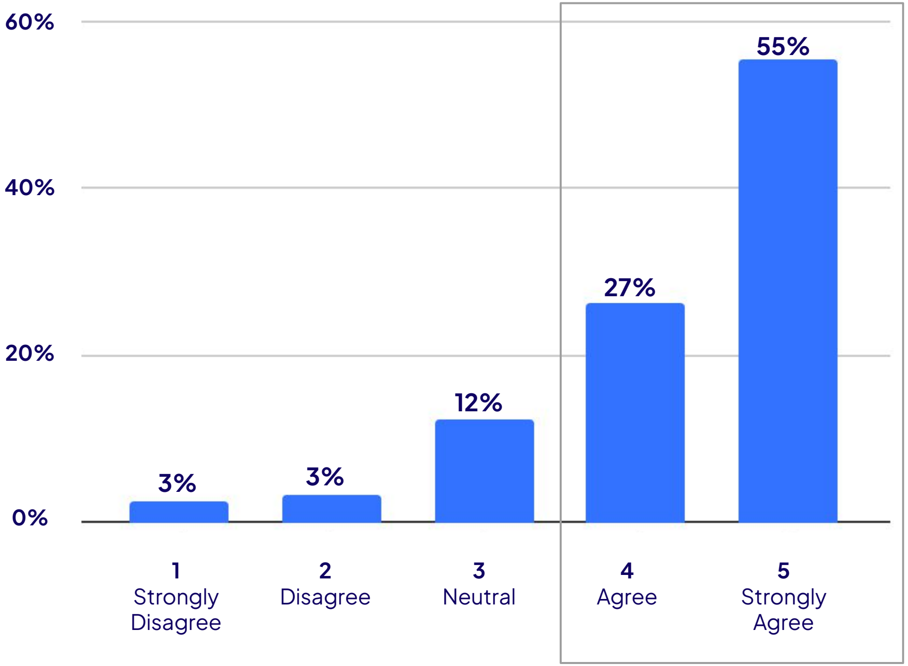
[1] Please refer to page 17 "Top 5 skills educators need for the AI era".

82% of faculty worry that students may become too reliant on AI

Concerned about students becoming too reliant on AI, % of respondents

Question: I am concerned about the following regarding AI integration into teaching:

- Students becoming too reliant on AI



82%

of faculty are worried about students becoming overly dependent on AI tools. More than half of them (55%) identified this issue as a significant concern,

AI Over-reliance

According to the Digital Education Council Global AI Student Survey 2024, 52% of students expressed concern that an over-reliance on AI could negatively impact their academic performance. These shared concerns between students and educators highlight the pressing need to promote appropriate use of AI in education.

5. Guidelines, Communication, and Resources

80% of faculty do not find institutional AI guidelines comprehensive

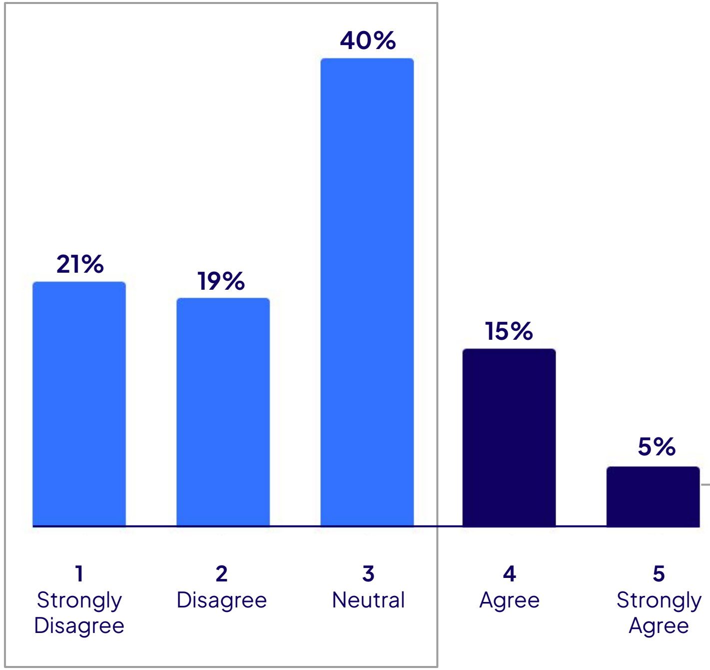
Faculty perceptions on comprehensiveness of their institutional AI guidelines, % of respondents

Question: To what extent do you agree or disagree with the statement?

- My institution has comprehensive AI guidelines for teaching

80%

of faculty do not find their institutional AI guidelines in teaching comprehensive.



5%

Only 5% of faculty perceive fully comprehensive institutional AI guidelines in teaching.

Lack of guidelines on AI in teaching

According to the Digital Education Council Executive Briefing #010 - Classifying AI Use Cases, AI guidelines in teaching are still in a relatively underdeveloped phase. Many areas, such as AI use in the classroom remain unregulated, leaving faculty with insufficient support and clarity.

Institutions have not made clear how AI can be used in teaching

Faculty perception on the clarity provided by their institution regarding AI use in teaching, % of respondents

Question: To what extent do you agree or disagree with the statement?

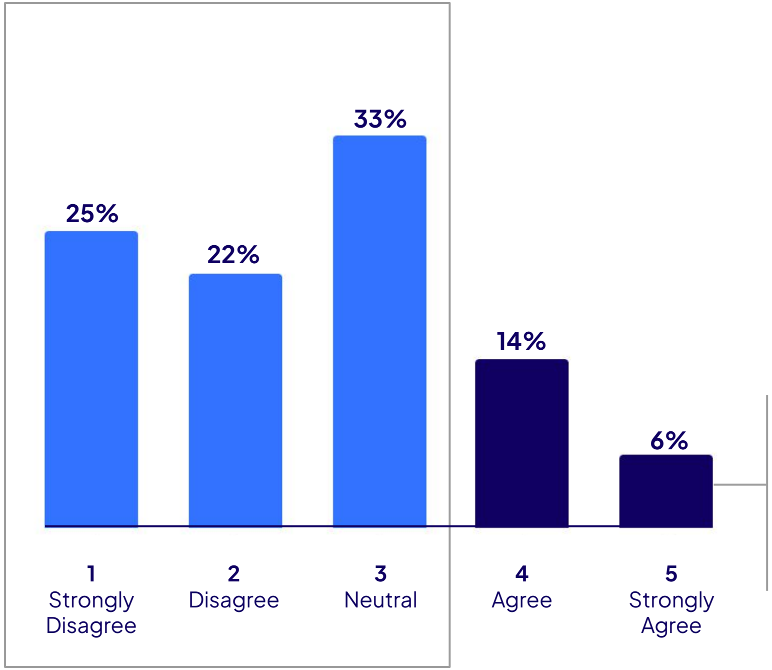
- My institution has made clear how AI can and cannot be used in teaching

80%

of faculty feel there is a lack of clarity on how AI can be applied in teaching within their institutions.

Lack of clarity on AI in teaching

The perceived lack of clarity regarding the use of AI in teaching may stem from insufficiently defined guidelines and communication, as highlighted in the DEC Executive Briefing #010 and #011.

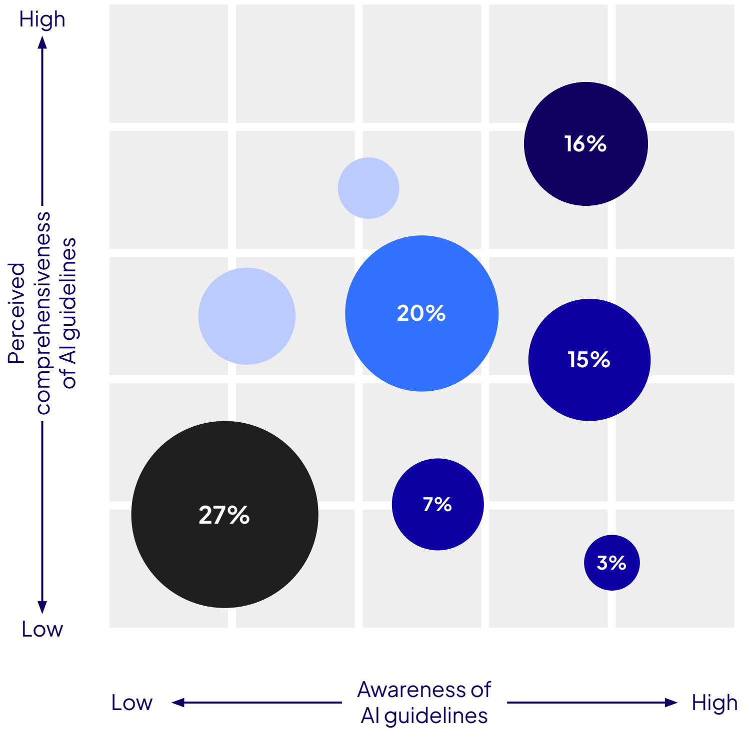


6%

Only 6% of faculty think their institution has clearly outlined how AI can be used in teaching.

Faculty call for improved AI guidelines and communications

Faculty awareness and perception of comprehensiveness of AI guidelines, % of respondents



Question: To what extent do you agree or disagree with the statement? (1–strongly disagree, 3–neutral, 5–strongly agree):

- My institution has comprehensive AI guidelines for teaching.
- I am aware of my institution's AI guidelines for teaching.

4% of faculty are fully aware of their institutional AI guidelines and feel they are fully comprehensive.

The Well-Informed, 16%
Faculty perceive their institution's AI guidelines as comprehensive and are well aware of them.

The "We can do better", 25%
Faculty are aware of their institution's AI guidelines but find them lacking in comprehensiveness.

The Uncertain, 20%
Faculty are unsure about the comprehensiveness of the AI guidelines and they have moderate level of awareness.

The Lost, 27%
Faculty are both unaware of the AI guidelines and believe them to be lacking in comprehensiveness. This is the most populated zone.

Only 6% of faculty are fully satisfied with AI literacy resources

Faculty sentiment on resources provided by institutions to develop faculty AI literacy, % of respondents

Question: To what extent do you agree or disagree with the statement?

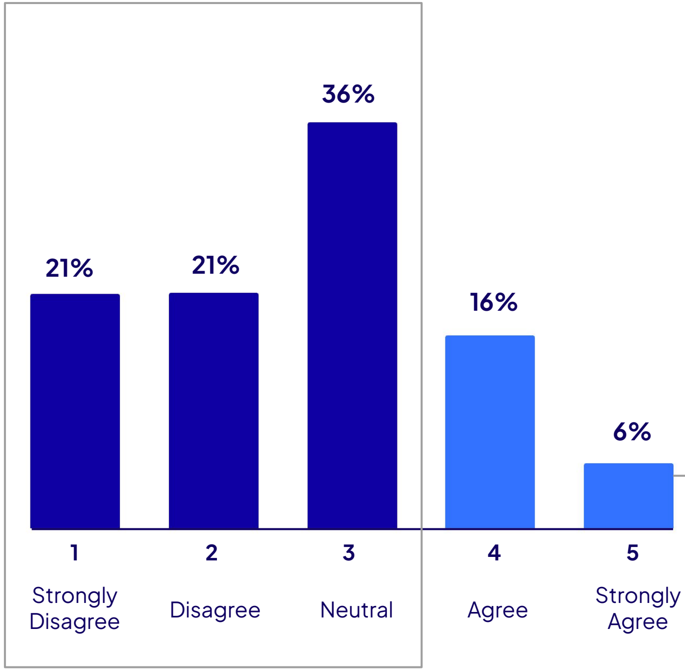
- My institution has provided sufficient resources to develop faculty AI literacy

78%

Over three-quarters of faculty do not find that their institutions have provided sufficient resources to developing faculty's AI literacy

Developing AI Literacy

Majority of faculty are not satisfied with resources provided to develop their AI literacy. This could hinder faculty confidence in working with AI, and dissuade them from exploring possible AI integrations and uses in their teaching.



6%

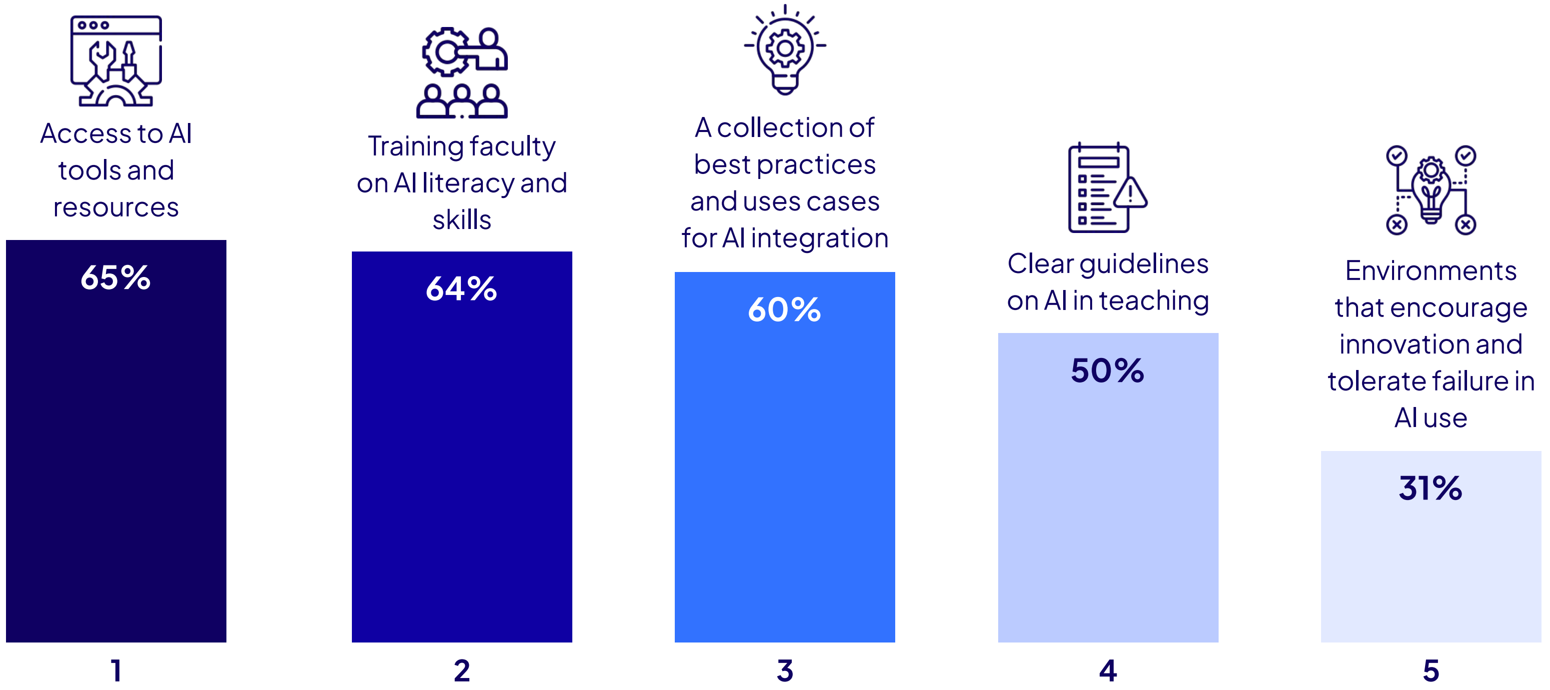
Only 6% of faculty fully agree that their institutions have provided sufficient resources to train faculty's AI literacy

Resources, training, and best practices can enable AI integration

Top 5 enablers for AI integration into teaching, % of respondents

Question: I believe that the following will enable me to integrate AI into teaching (choose up to 3)

*Responses only include respondents who indicated answered 'Yes' to 'I see myself using AI in my teaching practices in the future'



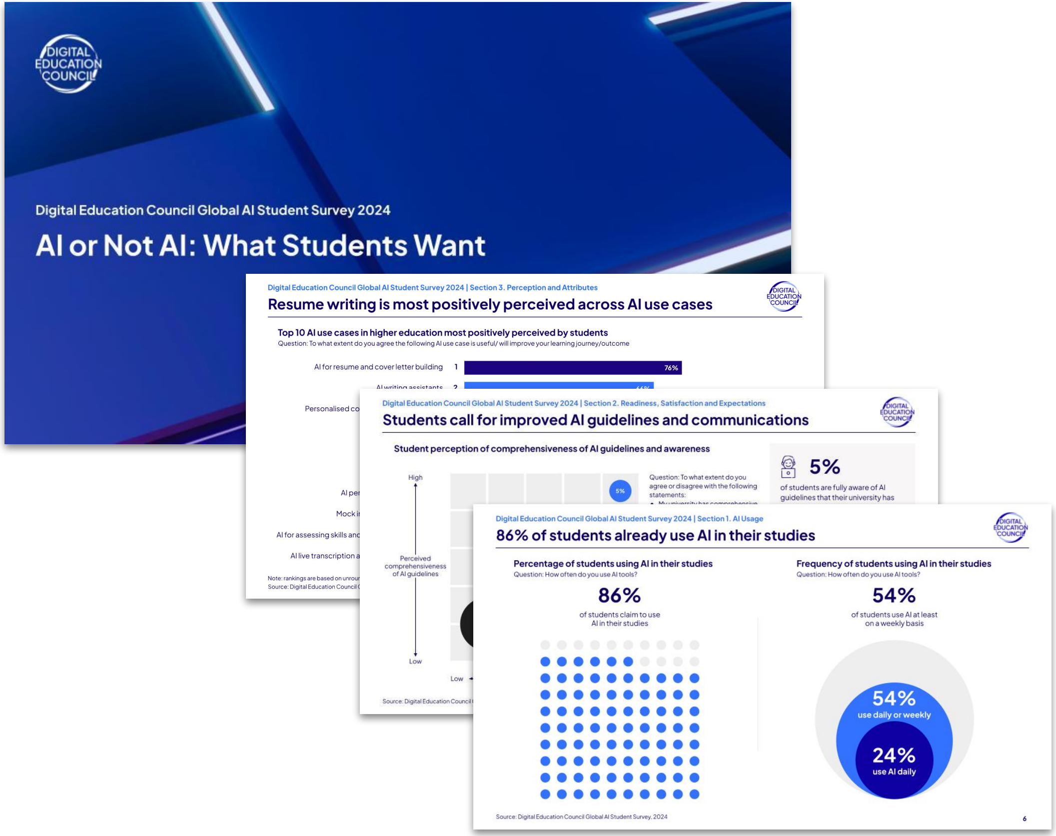
6. About DEC and Copyright Details

Digital Education Council Global AI Student Survey 2024

Prior to the Global AI Faculty Report, the Digital Education Council published the DEC Global AI Student Survey in August 2024, offering insights into student perceptions of AI in higher education. The report covers the status of AI usage and readiness, student perceptions of AI use cases, expectations and preferences for institution actions on AI, satisfaction with AI adoption, concerns and key attributes for AI use.

Together, our Faculty and Student Surveys aim to guide decision-making for higher education leadership.

Download here



Digital Education Council Executive Briefings

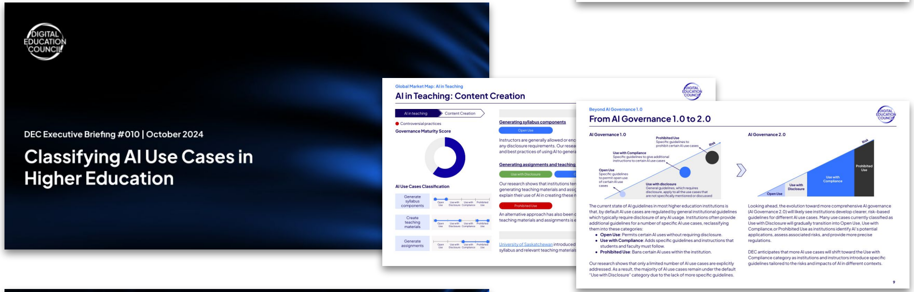
The Digital Education Council delivers monthly Reports and Executive Briefings to its members.

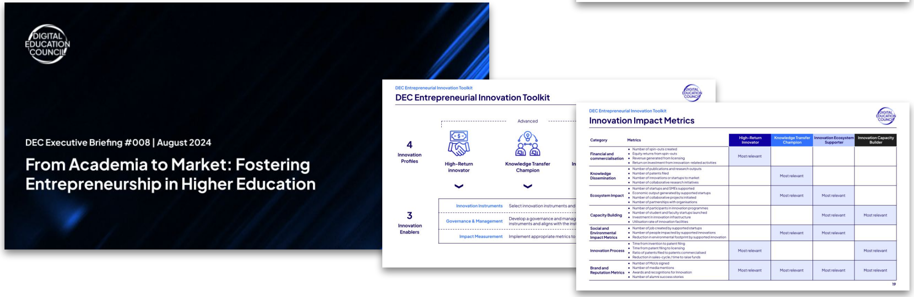
These Reports and Executive Briefings share key insights, practical frameworks and usable tools to support AI adoption, governance, and sustainable innovation in higher education.

Our members use these as key working documents to help them work through the transformation in the world of education and skills.

Explore

Examples of Executive Briefings





Digital Education Council Meetings

Thematic Working Groups

DEC Thematic Working Groups serve as a global platform for collaborative discussions for DEC members, fostering knowledge sharing and establishing best practices to drive innovation. The Thematic Working Groups are focussed on practical outcomes and run on a one-year cycle.

DEC Global Summit

The DEC Global Summit is an in-person and outcome-focussed event exclusively for DEC members. The Global Summit is a key opportunity to address global challenges and explore actionable strategies for positive integration of digital and artificial intelligence technologies.

Become a Member

Examples of Meetings

Copyright and Contact Details

Suggested Citation: Digital Education Council, *Global AI Faculty Survey*, 2025.

For additional requests and feedback please contact:

Hui Rong
Research and Intelligence Lead
hui@digitaleducationcouncil.com

Charlene Chun
Research and Intelligence Associate
charlene@digitaleducationcouncil.com

For membership enquiries please contact:

Maria Oliver Roman
Global Engagement and Operations Director
maria@digitaleducationcouncil.com